

EXPERIMENT 10

Performance Optimization in Zoho Creator

Subject: Low Code Application Development using Zoho Creator

Karpaga Sundari V

241401037

Aim

To demonstrate performance optimization techniques in the Event Registration application in Zoho Creator, particularly efficient record retrieval and workflow processing.

Introduction

Performance optimization in low-code applications means designing forms, workflows and scripts so that they use data and processing only as far as needed. Although a low-code platform handles much of the underlying work, the way in which a workflow is written still influences how efficiently it runs.

Retrieving more records than required, or repeatedly processing records that are not relevant to the task, causes unnecessary data retrieval and processing. In a small application this may not be noticeable, but as the number of records and users grows it can reduce application efficiency. Efficient workflows in Zoho Creator therefore retrieve only the data they need and avoid unnecessary processing, which supports scalable and maintainable applications.

Application Used

The practical was performed in Zoho Creator using the Event Registration application. Deluge scripting was used to write the logic of a form workflow that sends an email notification when a registration is submitted. No upgrade-only feature is claimed as enabled or configured in this record.

Performance Optimization Concept

The key optimization demonstrated is criteria-based record fetching. Instead of retrieving every record of a form, a criteria is given so that only the required record is returned. In the Event Registration workflow, this is written as:

```
eventRegistration = Event_Registration[ID == input.ID];
```

- The workflow identifies the current record using input.ID, which holds the ID of the record being processed.
- Only the relevant Event Registration record, the one whose ID matches input.ID, is retrieved.
- This avoids unnecessarily fetching and processing unrelated records.
- This improves workflow efficiency and reduces unnecessary data processing.

Procedure

1. Open the Event Registration application in Zoho Creator in Edit mode.
2. Navigate to the Workflow section and open Form workflows. The form Event Registration is listed under Forms with workflows.
3. Observe the form workflow "Send registration email". It is triggered on Created → Successful form submission, has 1 action and has the status Enabled (Figure 1).

Send registration email is enabled and runs on form submission

Event Registration

DesignWorkflowSettings

Form workflows

SchedulesApprovalsPaymentsBlueprintsBatch workflowsFunctions

Forms with workflows

Event Registration

Forms without workflows

Workflow Name	Details	Status
Created → Successful form submission		
Send registration email	1 Action	Enabled

Form workflow list · Send registration email enabled

Figure 1: Form Workflow of the Event Registration Application (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

4. When an Event Registration is submitted, the workflow identifies the current record using input.ID.
5. The required record is fetched using the criteria ID == input.ID, so that only this record is retrieved.
6. The workflow checks whether the email field of the record is blank.
7. If the email is available, the notification email is sent to the attendee. If the email is missing, an informational message is displayed.

The Deluge script used in the workflow is given in the next section.

Deluge Code

The Deluge code of the workflow is as follows:

```
eventRegistration = Event_Registration[ID == input.ID];

if(eventRegistration.email.isBlank())
{
    info "Email address is missing for this registration";
}
else
{
    sendmail
    [
        from :zoho.adminuserid
        to :eventRegistration.email
        subject : "Your Event Registration is Confirmed"
        message : "<p>Dear Attendee,</p><p>Your registration for the event has
been received. We look forward to seeing you.</p><p>Thank you for
registering.</p>"
    ]
}
```

The first statement fetches the record by its ID. If the email field of that record is blank, an informational message is displayed. Otherwise, an email with the subject "Your Event Registration is Confirmed" is sent to the attendee's email address.

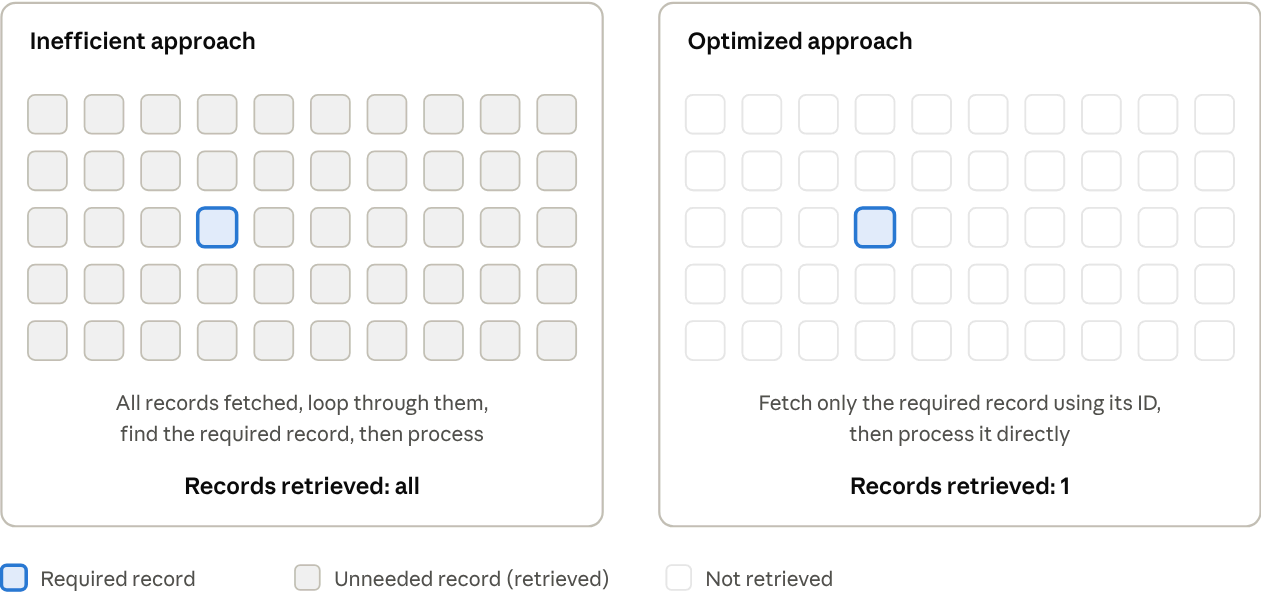
Performance Analysis

The optimized approach is compared with a general inefficient approach below.

Approach	Steps
Before (inefficient approach)	Fetch all records → iterate through records → find the required record → process
Optimized (used in the workflow)	Fetch the required record using ID → process directly

The inefficient approach retrieves and processes records that are not needed, whereas the optimized approach reduces unnecessary record retrieval and processing. Figure 2 is a conceptual illustration of this comparison, showing how many records each approach retrieves. The "before" code given after it is an illustrative example only; it was not used in the application.

The optimized approach retrieves 1 record instead of all of them



Records retrieved · inefficient vs optimized

Figure 2: Records Retrieved by the Inefficient and Optimized Approaches (Conceptual Diagram)

Illustrative comparison only (not used in the application):

```
eventRegistrations = Event_Registration[];
for each rec in eventRegistrations
{
    if(rec.ID == input.ID)
    {
        // ...
    }
}
```

No benchmark was performed in this practical, so no measured improvement in execution time is claimed. The comparison is based on the amount of data retrieved and processed.

Optimization Techniques

General practices that contribute to performance in Zoho Creator applications are given below and summarised in Figure 3, a conceptual diagram.

One technique is used, one is followed, and indexing is not configured

1	Criteria-Based Fetching Retrieve only the records required for the current operation.	Used in this practical
2	Avoid Unnecessary Loops Do not fetch all records and loop when a criterion can be used.	Followed
3	Built-in and Aggregate Operations Use built-in functions instead of repeated processing.	General practice
4	Indexed Fields Can improve retrieval of frequently queried data.	Not configured
5	Efficient Workflows Keep workflows simple; avoid nested or repeated operations.	General practice

Outcome of applying the techniques



Five optimization techniques and their status

Figure 3: Performance Optimization Techniques (Conceptual Diagram). Outcome: Less Data Retrieval → Less Processing → Better Workflow Efficiency → Scalable Application

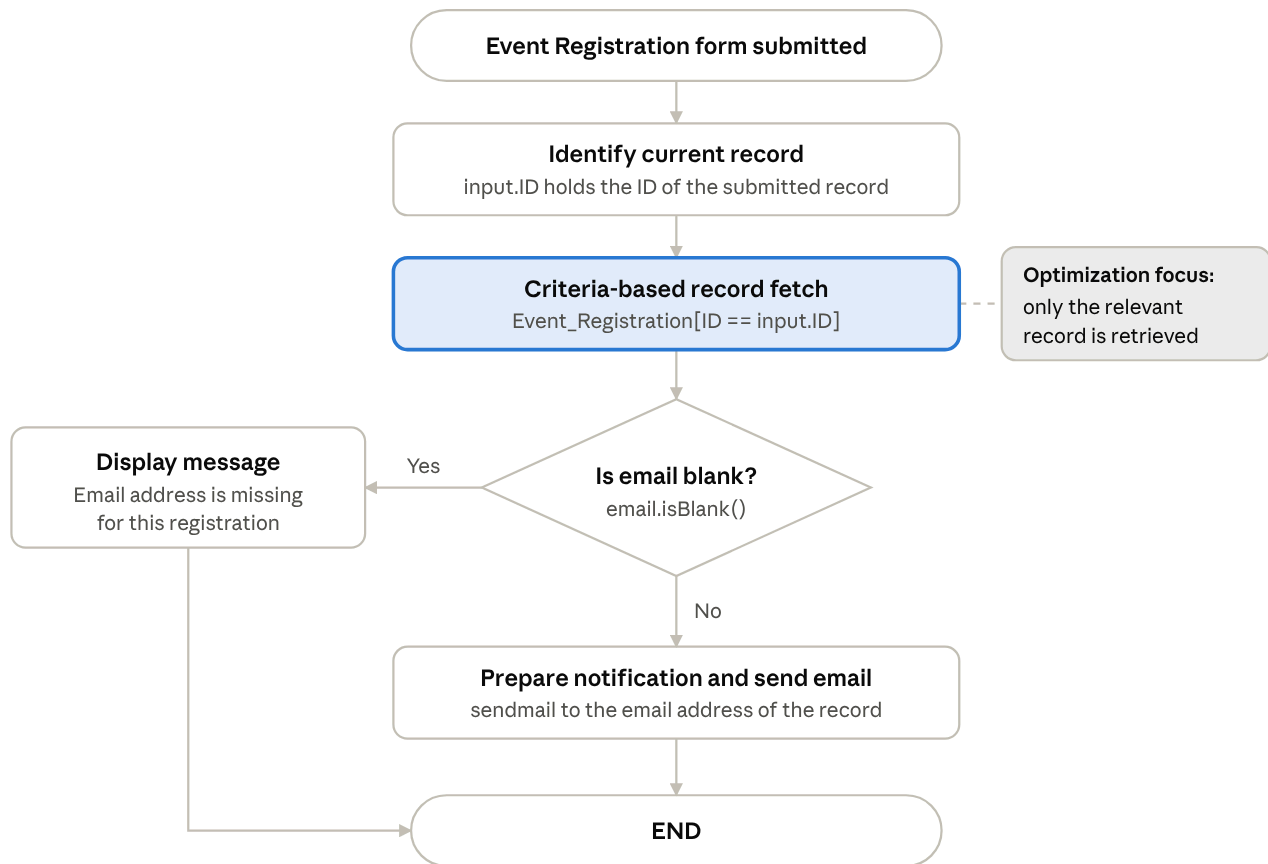
Technique	Explanation
Criteria-based record fetching	Retrieve only the records required for the current operation. This technique is used in the practical.
Avoiding unnecessary record iteration	Do not fetch all records and loop through them when a specific criterion can be used.
Efficient built-in functions and aggregate operations	Use built-in functions and aggregate operations instead of unnecessary repeated processing.
Indexed fields	Indexed fields can improve retrieval performance for frequently queried data. Indexing may require backend / platform configuration, and it was not enabled or configured in this application.
Efficient workflows	Keep workflows simple and avoid unnecessary nested or repeated operations.

Optimized Workflow

Figure 4 is a conceptual flowchart of the optimized Event Registration workflow:

Event Registration Submitted → Identify Current Record → Criteria-Based Record Fetch → Validate Email → Prepare Notification → Send Email

Only the relevant record is fetched before the email check



Optimized workflow · flowchart

Figure 4: Optimized Event Registration Workflow (Conceptual Diagram)

- **Identify current record:** input.ID gives the ID of the submitted record.
- **Criteria-based record fetch:** Event_Registration[ID == input.ID] retrieves only the relevant record.
- **Validate email:** email.isBlank() checks whether the email field is empty.
- **Prepare notification and send email:** if the email is available, the notification message is prepared and sent using sendmail; otherwise an informational message is displayed.

Conclusion

Performance optimization is important in low-code applications because efficiency depends not only on the platform but also on how workflows and scripts are written. In this practical, the Event Registration workflow used criteria-based record retrieval with

the expression `Event_Registration[ID == input.ID]`, so that only the required record was retrieved and processed.

Targeted record retrieval improves efficiency by avoiding the retrieval of unrelated records and the iteration through them, and efficient workflow design reduces unnecessary processing. Practices such as criteria-based fetching, avoiding unnecessary loops, using built-in operations and keeping workflows simple help applications to handle growing amounts of data. These practices contribute to scalable and maintainable Zoho Creator applications. No benchmark was performed, so the benefits are described in terms of reduced data retrieval and processing and not as measured execution times.